Revision Date:
12/01/2023

Background:
California has opted into the federal regulation which allows states the option to offer Transitional CalFresh (TCF) benefits to households (HH) leaving the CalWORKs program. TCF benefits ensure HHs can continue to meet their nutritional needs once they are no longer receiving the cash benefits.

Purpose:
This section defines the TCF program, identifies when the program should be implemented, and explains the TCF recertification process. The section is being revised to merge together all information regarding TCF.

Policy:
A HH receiving Public Assistance CalFresh (PACF) in the month their CalWORKs discontinues must automatically be provided TCF benefits if CalWORKs discontinues for a qualifying reason. At least one HH member must have received CalWORKs and PACF in the month CalWORKs discontinues for the HH to be eligible for TCF.

When a HH is approved for TCF, the benefits will begin the first of the month following the CalWORKs discontinuance. A CalFresh Notice of Approval/Termination Transitional Benefits (CF 1239) shall be sent to the HH upon TCF approval. The TCF certification period will be five-months and TCF benefits will remain unchanged for the duration of the certification period. At the end of the certification period the HH will be required to recertify to regular CalFresh, or the benefits will discontinue. In no circumstance shall TCF benefits be issued for more than five months.

1. Conditions of Eligibility to TCF

A HH is eligible to TCF, if CalWORKs discontinues for one of the following reasons and the HH is receiving PACF in the month of discontinuance.

- HH exceeded the income or property limit.
- HH requested to close CalWORKs.
- The only eligible HH member was a parent and the parent timed out.
- The only eligible HH member was a child and the child aged out.
- The only eligible HH member(s) were children, and they left the home.
- HH is disqualified due to a CalWORKs rule change.
- Whereabouts unknown.
- Only adult in the case is incarcerated.

A HH would **not be eligible** to TCF if CalWORKs discontinues for one of the following reasons, even if they were receiving PACF in the month of discontinuance.

- HH was approved Supplemental Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) or Temporary Assistance to Needy Families (TANF) in another state.
- All HH members are sanctioned.
- Incomplete or failure to submit an Eligibility Status Report (SAR 7).
- Incomplete or failure to submit the CalWORKs redetermination.

- HH moved out of state.
- A HH containing two or more CalWORKs cases in which all of the CalWORKs cases are not being discontinued.
- All HH members are deceased.
- Failure to provide information/verification necessary to determine CalWORKs eligibility.
- The CalWORKs grant decreases to a zero basic grant.
- HH issued diversion payments instead of CalWORKs.
- HH issued CalWORKs immediate need and is later denied CalWORKs.

Note: A HH discontinuing from Refugee Cash Assistance (RCA), General Relief (GR), or Cash Assistance Program for Immigrants (CAPI) is not eligible to TCF.

2. TCF HH Members

All HH members receiving PACF, that are not sanctioned from CalWORKs in the month CalWORKs discontinues, will be eligible to TCF. TCF benefits will be calculated excluding the CalWORKs sanctioned individual from the TCF HH size. In addition, any HH member who was ineligible to PACF in the month CalWORKs discontinued will also be ineligible to TCF.

Example:	
Scenario	HH of 3 (mom and 2 minor children) is receiving CalWORKs and PACF. Mom is sanctioned from CalWORKs for failure to comply with Welfare to Work (WTW). She is receiving PACF due to a work registration exemption. On May 5th the HH reports mom started working and the HH is over income for the CalWORKs program.
Outcome	CalWORKs discontinues as of May 31st. TCF is approved as of June 1st for a HH of 2. Mom is ineligible to receive TCF since she was sanctioned from CalWORKs in the month of discontinuance.

3. Calculation of TCF Benefits

TCF benefits are calculated using the existing income that was in the PACF budget in the final month the HH received CalWORKs minus the CalWORKs grant. The new or increased income that may have resulted in the loss of CalWORKs will not be counted when calculating the TCF benefits.

Example:	
Scenario	HH of 2 (mom and 1 child, age 5) receiving CalWORKs and PACF. Mom was earning $600 bi-weekly, and they pay $1000 per month in rent + Standard Utility Allowance (SUA). On July 10, 2023, HH reports mom's income increased to $1200 bi-weekly, which exceeds the CalWORKs income limit. CalWORKs discontinues for over income. The HH is eligible to TCF as of August 1, 2023.
Outcome	The TCF HH would consist of mom and 1 child.

Budget	July 2023	August 2023
Earned income	$1300.20	$1300.20
CalWORKs grant	$545	$0
Shelter	$1000	$1000
SUA	$560	$560
CalFresh Allotment	$285	-
TCF Allotment	-	$449

4. Incorrect TCF Benefits and Overissuance Calculation

If TCF benefits are correctly computed based on the PACF benefits the HH received in the final month of CalWORKs, both the county and the HH shall be held harmless for inaccuracies in the TCF benefit due to prior errors in the PACF benefit. When the PACF amount issued during the last month of CalWORKs could not be decreased because timely notice could not be given to reduce the benefits. The TCF benefit amount will be based on what the HH was receiving at the time of the CalWORKs discontinuance and no overissuance will be created. TCF benefit overissuances shall only be created for the following reasons:

- The initial TCF benefit amount was determined incorrectly due to county error.
- The TCF benefit amount erroneously increased during the five-month certification period.

Note: Overissuances being recouped in the month of CalWORKs discontinuance will continue to be recouped during the TCF period.

HHs are not required to report any changes during the TCF period, nor will action be taken on any changes reported. Once TCF benefits are calculated, they will be frozen for the duration of the TCF certification period. TCF benefits will **not** be recalculated or terminated even if the following changes occur:

- HH moves out of the state.
- HH moves in with another HH who has active CalFresh, and they report to Purchase and Prepare (P&P) together or are restricted HH members.
- Case is Inter-County Transferred (ICT).
- A HH member becomes ineligible to CalFresh e.g.: ineligible student.
- HH has out-of-state Electronic Benefit Transfer (EBT) usage.

The following are exceptions and action must be taken to recalculate or discontinue TCF during the five-month certification period:

If…	**then…**
HH requests discontinuance of TCF,	discontinue TCF.
CalWORKs is rescinded,	discontinue TCF.
the entire HH is approved CalWORKs (TANF) and/or CalFresh (SNAP) benefits in any other case, county, or state,	discontinue TCF.
if an individual member of the HH is approved CalWORKs (TANF) and/or CalFresh (SNAP) benefits in any other case, county, or state,	the TCF benefit amount shall be recalculated for the remaining HH members by removing the individual from the HH along with his/her income and expenses.
the HH fails or refuses to cooperate with a Quality Control (QC) review,	discontinue TCF.
an individual is determined to be an Intentional Program Violator (IPV) while the HH is receiving TCF,	the TCF benefit amount shall be recalculated by removing the IPV as an eligible HH member while continuing to count their income in the TCF budget.

Note: An individual may not receive CalWORKs and TCF simultaneously.

5. Recission of CalWORKs After TCF is Approved

When the CalWORKs discontinuance is rescinded within 30 days of the discontinuance date due to good cause, TCF will be transferred back to PACF the following month and CalFresh benefits will be re-calculated. An overissuance will not be created, because TCF was correctly granted based on available information at the time CalWORKs discontinued. When the HH is transferred to PACF from TCF, the recertification month must be transferred back to the original recertification month prior to TCF being granted.

6. Reapplication of CalWORKs After TCF is Approved

A HH may reapply and be approved for CalWORKs after TCF is approved. When that happens the HH will be transferred back to PACF, and benefits shall be re-calculated based on the information provided on the application. The recertification date for CalFresh must be aligned with the recertification date of the newly approved CalWORKs case. The HH may receive one or two months of TCF before PACF is issued, depending on when CalWORKs is approved.

Example:	
Scenario	CalWORKs discontinues March 31, 2023, due to over income. TCF is approved April 1, 2023, thru August 31, 2023. The HH reapplies for CalWORKs on May 10, 2023, and is approved CalWORKs on June 5, 2023, for a twelve-month certification period with a redetermination due in April 2024.
Outcome	Since the HH cannot receive CalWORKs and TCF simultaneously, once CalWORKs is approved TCF must be transferred back to PACF with benefits re-calculated based on the information reported on the CalWORKs application. TCF must be terminated and transferred back to PACF as of July 1, 2023, and the recertification date for CalFresh will be aligned with CalWORKs to April 2024.

7. Recertification During the TCF Period

HHs receiving TCF may elect to recertify eligibility to CalFresh at any time during the five-month TCF certification period. In order to recertify, the HH shall submit an application for recertification. When the HH elects to recertify during the first four months of the TCF certification period, benefits may increase or decrease once recertified to regular CalFresh. HHs have the option to withdraw the recertification application and continue TCF if this is more advantageous to them.

The table below identifies the process staff must follow when the HH elects to recertify TCF benefits in the first four months of the TCF period.

If…	**then…**
staff determine that the HH is entitled to more CalFresh benefits than it is currently receiving for TCF and TCF benefits have already been issued for the first month of the certification period,	issue a supplement for the first month of the CalFresh certification period. The new certification period will begin the first of the month following the month the HH submitted the application for recertification. A CF 1239 shall be sent to the HH informing them of the TCF discontinuance.
The HH is determined to be ineligible for regular CalFresh,	deny the application. TCF will continue until the end of five-month certification period and the regular

	recertification process will be initiated the fourth month of the TCF certification period.
The HH is determined eligible for CalFresh, but is entitled to a benefit lower than their current TCF benefit,	ask if the HH would like to withdraw their application for recertification allowing them to continue receiving TCF until the end of the five-month certification period. If the HH chooses to continue with the recertification, process the recertification and begin a new certification period. A CF 1239 shall be sent to the HH informing them of the TCF discontinuance.
The application for recertification is denied for a reason besides the HH being ineligible to regular CalFresh,	deny the application. TCF will continue until the end of five-month certification period and the regular recertification process will be initiated the fourth month of the TCF certification period.

Example:	
Scenario	HH applies on May 25th for recertification, May is the third month of the TCF certification period. The HH is determined eligible to more CalFresh benefits than they are currently receiving for TCF.
Outcome	The new certification period for regular CalFresh will begin June 1st. If the HH already got TCF benefits for June, a supplement will be issued.

8. Recertification at the End of the TCF Period

At the end of the five-month TCF certification period, the HH must recertify eligibility to regular CalFresh. The HH will receive a Notice of Expiration (NEC) in the fourth month, informing them their benefits will terminate at the end of the following month if a recertification is not completed. A CalFresh recertification application and packet will be sent to the HH. TCF recertification follows the same rules as regular CalFresh recertification. For information regarding CalFresh recertification refer to section 63-304 Recertification.

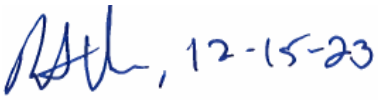
References:

CFR 273.27
MPP 63-504.13
ACL 03-66, 08-22, 08-22E, 11-70, 13-88, 20-129
ACIN I-21-04, I-72-04, I-34-05, I-75-05, I-58-08, I-54-09, I-84-09, I-41-10, I-50-12, I-53-20

Sunset Date:

This policy will be reviewed for continuance on or by 12/31/2026.

Approval for Release:



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